was formed in the middle of the 20th century, and under Jagernath Lachmon, gained prominence in Surinamese politics. However, tensions with the Afro-Surinamese on the question of social integration led the VHP to prefer continued Dutch rule as a form of mediation. Then, unlike anything that had happened in the British or French Caribbean, more than a 1,00,000 Surinamese Indians migrated to the Netherlands in the early 1970s, given the uncertainty about their future in post-Dutch Suriname. After Independence in 1975, political affairs descended into military rule for a brief period before stabilizing, leading to less Hindustani emigration. People of Indian origin now constitute around a quarter of the local population, but more significantly, a new Hindustani diaspora has emerged in the Netherlands.

In addition to the Caribbean and Mascarene world of sugar plantations, Indians also migrated to the remote Pacific islands of Fiji in Oceania, thanks to the brainwave of one colonial official. Arthur Hamilton Gordon, Governor of Fiji, had previously served as the Governor of Trinidad and Mauritius and seen how effective the Indian indentured system was on sugar plantations.[16] When the British acquired the Fiji islands in 1874, Gordon replaced cotton with sugar as a way to develop the islands and began negotiations for indentured labour. The first batch of nearly 500 Indians soon arrived aboard the *Leonidas* in 1879.

Between 1879 and 1916, around 60,000 indentured Indians migrated to Fiji, and less than a half returned to India. Three-fourths of the migrants were from north India while the rest were south Indians. All of them came from the zones identified with the Great Indian Migration Wave. The five-year indenture contract was called the *girmit* and the migrants were called *girmitiya*s who worked for nine hours a day for five and a half days a week. Girmitiyas were of all castes and became *jahaji bhai*s during the month-long sea crossing, a bond that lasted for a long time in the remote islands where caste identities would eventually dissolve. The main sugar planter in Fiji was the Australia-based Colonial Sugar Refining (CSR) Company, with practices that were not particularly tuned to modern-day notions of CSR. High mortality, and even suicides, plagued the fate of Indian labourers in